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FireCrawl: Notes for Beginners

Firecrawl is a tool that converts websites into clean, AI-friendly data. It can extract webpage content as Markdown or structured data, crawl multiple pages and make website information easier to use in Python data analysis and AI applications.

1. What is Firecrawl used for?

- Extract text from websites.
- Scrape multiple webpages.
- Crawl a whole website and discover links
- Convert HTML pages into Markdown.
- Extract structured data, such as product names and prices.
- Collect information for AI apps, research and data analysis.

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2. Install Firecrawl in Python.

Install the offical Python SDK:

pip install firecrawl-py

You also need an API Key fom firecrawl's offical website. The python SDK uses this Key to access the services.

3. Scrape a single website.

Python

```
from firecrawl import Firecrawl
app = Firecrawl (api_key = "Your_API_KEY")
result = app.scrape (
        "https://example.com",
        formats = ["markdown"]
)
print (result.markdown)
```

Explanation:

- Firecrawl() connects to the API
- app.scrape() extracts content from one webpage.
- formats = ["markdown"] requests clean Markdown text
- result.markdown displays the extracted content 2

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Replace Your_API_KEY with you actual API Key. Keep it private.

4. Scrape Vs Crawl Vs. Map

Method	Purpose
scrape()	Extract data from one webpage
crawl()	Extract data from multiple linked pages.
map()	Discover URLs on a website
search	Search the web for relevant information.

These are key Firecrawl operations in the Python SDK.

5. Crawl multiple pages.

```
from firecrawl import Firecrawl
app = Firecrawl(api_key = "Your_API_KEY")

result = app.crawl(
    "https://example.com",
    limit = 10
)
print(result)
```

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6. Convert scraped data into a DataFrame.
Once ~~You've~~ we've collected webpage results, you've can use pandas ~~from~~ for analyses.

Python.

```
import pandas as pd.
# Example extracted results.
data = [
    {"title": "Product A", "price": 100},
    {"title": "Product B", "price": 200}
]
df = pd.DataFrame(data)
print(df)
df.to_csv("scraped_data.csv", index=False)
```

This uses sample data to demonstrate the workflow. To save real Firecrawl results, first extract the relevant fields from its response.

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7. Advantages and Limitations.

Advantages.

- Reduces manual HTML parsing.
- Supports crawling multiple pages.
- Returns clean content suitable for data analysis and AI
- Can request structured output for supported extraction tasks.

Limitations

- Requires an API Key
- Usage may be limited by our accounts plan and credits.
- Some websites restrict automated access.
- Extracted information can be incomplete or inaccurate.

Build a Job listing Scraper.

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